



The X Writing Playbook

**How to Grow an Audience
and Build a Brand in Public**

Andrei Lucian

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1. Profile optimisation

Before you chase reach, fix what people see when they click you: **your profile**. Photo, banner, and bio should answer in seconds: *who is this, what do they stand for, and why follow*.

Checklist:

- **Profile image (avatar)** — **Your face**, plain and simple: well lit, in focus, easy to recognise at thumbnail size. Not a logo, not a tiny figure in a crowd. You can **smile** or stay **serious**; either works if your face is clearly visible.
- **Cover image (banner)** — Something you **offer** or promise: a result people want, a problem you own, or a reason they should **follow you**. One bold idea; no wallpaper noise.
- **Bio** — use the formula on the following pages; add proof last.

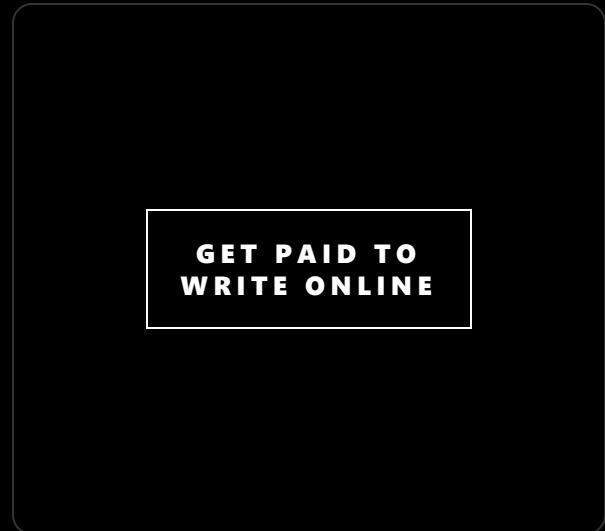
Examples for photo and banner are on the next page.

Profile image & cover

a) Profile image — your face, clearly



b) Cover image — your offer / reason to follow



Quick rules

- **Avatar:** Must be **your face** — close enough that people see *you* clearly (eyes, expression). Good light, simple background. Smile or serious is fine; avoid hiding behind hats, dark shadows, or busy crops.
- **Cover:** Say **what you offer** or what people **gain** by following you — a result, a belief, or a clear theme. Make it something they **want**, not decoration. Huge text, one idea, readable on mobile.

Bio — the formula

Build your headline and about section around:

I help **X** doing **Y** with **Z**

- **X** — who (niche / segment)
- **Y** — outcome they want
- **Z** — your mechanisms (how)

Below is a filled example you can adapt — not a template to copy verbatim.

Example bio + social proof



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

I help B2B founders get noticed & get leads with Personal Branding, Content Strategy & B2B Growth.

Social proof: 30+ clients · 8M+ views (swap for your numbers)

Map to the formula

- I help **X** ⇒ B2B founders
- doing **Y** ⇒ get noticed & get leads
- with **Z** ⇒ Personal Branding, Content Strategy, B2B Growth

Social proof answers “why believe you?” — keep it one line.

Writing on social is simple (not easy).

You only need two things.

Your writing has to **look good** and **be useful**.

You make it **useful** with the **content goals**:

- Education
- Inspiration
- Entertainment

You make it look good with **aesthetic writing** — easy to consume. It includes (but isn't limited to):

- Rule of 3
- Simplicity
- Stairways
- Polarizing
- Repetition
- Bullet points
- White space
- Write as you speak
- Vary sentence length

There's more I teach clients — this is the 20% that gets most of the result. Let's go.

Rule of 3

The rule of 3 improves rhythm. More clarity, more persuasive, more memorable. It's usually stronger than one or two items — use 3s in lists when you can.

Example:



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

Most founders:

- Chase vanity
- Copy trends
- Ignore positioning

Me:

- Niche down
- Ship proof
- Own one story

Pick a lane.



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

Most founders:

- Chase vanity
- Ignore positioning

Me:

- Niche down
- Ship proof
- Own one story
- Post daily

Pick a lane.

Simplicity

Don't use more words when fewer will do. People are busy. Write like it.

- Simple
- Concise
- Practical

Simplicity reads like confidence.

Example:



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

You don't need more tactics.

You need one offer people understand.



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

You don't necessarily need to keep adding tactics if you're feeling overwhelmed; what you probably need is to simplify your offer so prospects actually understand what you do and why it matters.

Stairways make your writing look organised. It's underrated.

- Stands out
- Looks intentional
- Easy to read

Order lines by length so the eye travels down cleanly.

Example:



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

The 1% creator:

Stoic
Writer
Consistent
Systems-first
Boring on purpose



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

The 1% creator:

Boring on purpose
Stoic
Systems-first
Writer
Consistent

Dare to make clear statements. You'll get some pushback — and you'll attract the right people. Stand for what you believe.

Example:



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

I'll be happy once I hit the milestone.

Hits milestone

Still stressed.

Why?

Outcomes alone won't fix how you operate.



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

I'll be happy once I hit the milestone. *Hits milestone* Still stressed. Why? Outcomes alone won't fix how you operate.

Repetition

Repetition improves readability. Use the same opener on list lines to create rhythm.

✗ Many posts · Lots of tweets · A lot of writing

✓ Lots of posts · Lots of tweets · Lots of writing

Example:



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

Building in public is hard.

- Lots of doubt
- Lots of drafts
- Lots of silence

Still better than hiding your work.



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

Building in public is hard.

- Plenty of doubt
- Many drafts
- Endless silence

Still better than hiding your work.

Bullet points

Bullet points have lots of benefits.

- Easier to read
- Easier to notice
- Easier to consume

Pick • over - when you can. Use more bullets in feed posts.

Example:



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

Want inbound from LinkedIn?

- Positioning
- Proof
- Consistent posts
- Clear CTA

Start with one.



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

Want inbound from LinkedIn? Positioning, proof, consistent posts, clear CTA — start with one.

White space

White space is incredibly important.

- Easier to read
- Easier to intrigue
- Easier to understand

It lowers the perceived effort to read your post — so more people finish it. Add space after short lines.

Example:



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

I'll be happy once I ship the launch.

Ships launch

Still anxious.

Why?

The next milestone won't fix your habits.



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

I'll be happy once I ship the launch. *Ships launch* Still anxious. Why? The next milestone won't fix your habits.

Write as you speak · sentence length

You should write as you speak. Beginners try to sound smart — it backfires. If you wouldn't say it out loud, don't type it.

Vary sentence length. Short. Then a longer line that carries one clear idea — then short again. Monotone length feels like a textbook.

Example:



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

You don't need a perfect plan.

You need to post for 90 days and iterate.



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

One does not require an elaborate multi-quarter strategic roadmap prior to commencement of organic distribution efforts; one requires a sustained publishing cadence over a finite horizon.

Inspirational content

Inspirational posts are great for growth. Focus on **empathy**, **milestones**, **transformation**. It builds trust, growth, and likeability.

INSPIRATIONAL CONTENT

EMPATHY



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

Client work is messy.

Late nights. Quiet weeks. Doubt.

Still beats pretending you have it
figured out online.

MILESTONE



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

90 days ago I restarted posting.

Today: [your metric].

Trust the reps.

TRANSFORMATION



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

2022: hiding behind "busy"

2026: shipping in public

Swap the story you tell yourself.

Educational content

People want valuable information. Great educational posts maximise value per second. Focus on **proof**, **insights**, **strategies**. It increases trust and authority.

EDUCATIONAL CONTENT

PROOF



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

We rewrote one founder's headline + first line of posts.

14 days later: 2× profile visits (example — use your real numbers).

NICHE INSIGHTS



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

Most LinkedIn bios fail for one reason:

They describe a job title — not an outcome the reader wants.

STRATEGIES



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

Weekly system:

- 3 posts
- 60 min engagement
- 5 real DMs

Repeat.

Entertainment content

A lot of people just want to be entertained. You don't need to become a comedian — just a bit more human. Focus on **jokes**, **anecdotes**, **polarizing takes**. It increases likeability and memorability.

ENTERTAINMENT CONTENT

POLARIZING TAKES



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

Vanity metrics are a hobby.

Pipeline is a business.

JOKES



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

Personal branding is like going to the gym.

You start for "credibility."

You stay for the weird DMs.

ANECDOTES



Andrei Lucian ✓
@theandreilucian

I once spent a week "optimising" a banner.

Zero leads.

Rewrote one line of the bio — replies came back.

Practical gameplan

Batch hooks on Sunday. Ship 3–5 posts per week. Protect one engagement block daily.

DAY	CONTENT	ENGAGE	DMS
Mon	Draft / schedule 2 posts; pick templates	60 min (split: yours + niche feed)	5–10 thoughtful
Tue	Publish + one comment capture / story	60 min	5–10
Wed	How-to or framework post	60 min	5–10
Thu	Proof or opinion	60 min	5–10
Fri	Review saves / replies; steal your own format	45 min	Optional
Sat–Sun	Batch next week’s hooks; optional carousel	Light / off	Off

Adjust to your bandwidth — keep the *structure*, not every number.

Rotate formats so you never run out of ideas. **Pillar mix:** proof, opinion, how-to. Every post should make one idea stick.

Templates 1–5

1. Mistake → fix
2. List breakdown (3–5 bullets)
3. Story → lesson
4. Contrarian hook + nuance
5. Before / after

Templates 6–10

6. Carousel / document
7. DM prompt (sparingly)
8. Comment capture + answer
9. Founder diary
10. Resource drop

Cadence: e.g. Mon opinion · Wed how-to · Fri story — tune to you.

Micro-example



3 signs your LinkedIn bio is invisible:

- No niche
- No outcome
- No proof

Fix one today.



Here are some thoughts about branding and how it can be important for trust in various contexts.

Engagement game

60 minutes per day — budget this for real interaction (not doom-scrolling).

A) Reply to people who engage on your posts. Don't answer with one word like "yes", "ye", or "indeed" — use **at least one full sentence**, and add a question or next step when it fits.



Makes sense — we saw the same after generic sequences. Are you fixing with better segmentation or turning automations off?



yes

B) Leave **30–100 comments per day** on other people's posts (pick a realistic range). Insight, not links — comments are borrowed distribution.

Examples (feed-style lines you might comment under)



Creator ✓
@example

The best teachers often share their journey while climbing, not just the view from the top.



Creator ✓
@example

The gap between starting messy and staying stuck in research mode is where most opportunities actually live.

“Your network is your net worth.”

Most people lead with taking. Flip it: **curiosity** → **value** → **optional call**. Target **20–30 real DMs per day** only to people you’d actually talk to.

Mindset

- Genuine interest in their work; value before asks
- Reference something specific they posted
- OK being ignored — not a verdict on you

Avoid “let’s connect” with no context, needy tone, “hi” with no hook, hollow reciprocity, giant voice notes.

DM openers & depth

Steps 1–3 — Find people through comments; follow + warm up; first message = why their post/bio hit (short).

Hey [name] — your [post/bio] landed because [specific reason]. Optional: one question.

Inspiration, not 30 copy-pastes.

Steps 4–5 — Ask about what they're building; offer a useful note or intro when it's real (not manipulation).

Steps 6–7 — Short call if values align; move great fits to Telegram / email. Skip hollow pods.

Small vs big creators: bigger inboxes need a sharper reason to reply. Lead with value; stay non-needy; treat them as peers, not idols.

Weekly rhythm

- Mon — draft/schedule posts; refresh bio if needed
- Tue–Thu — engagement + outbound DMs
- Fri — review what earned saves/replies
- Weekend — optional long-form or carousel

Signals you're winning: strangers cite your themes; DMs get specific; you can predict saves vs comments.

Today

1. Photo, banner, bio (formula)
2. Schedule 3 posts from your templates
3. 60 min: comments + replies
4. 5 thoughtful DMs

If you're stuck

- **Low views?** Fix the first two lines (hook).
- **No DMs?** Proof + CTA in bio; end posts with a question.
- **Burnout?** One post/day + keep the engagement block sacred.

DM me



Ghostwriting — for B2B founders who want a repeatable system: positioning, hooks, and cadence — not guesswork.

Brand advising — for small creators who want to grow on X, build an audience, and monetize — from **0** → **1000** followers in the next **120 days**.

DM ME